

SLICK DESKTOP CUSTOMIZATION GUIDE



Guide by Joakim Wahlgren. Edited by Joey Sneddon.

It won pride of place as [one of our top 5 readers desktops](#) and now, using this guide, you can get the very same look on your own Ubuntu 10.10 desktop.



Apps and sources

The first step is to add repositories for the following: -

- Nautilus-elementary
- Faenza Icons
- Orta theme
- Virtualbox Indicator
- Caffeine Indicator
- Ubuntu One Indicator

These provide us with all the apps and themes we need to get 'the look'.

I find the quickest way to add the necessary repositories is via the Terminal (Applications > Terminal).

Enter the following: -

sudo add-apt-repository ppa:am-monkeyd/nautilus-elementary-ppa && sudo add-apt-repository ppa:tiheum/equinox && sudo add-apt-repository ppa:nikount/orta-desktop && sudo add-apt-repository ppa:michael-astrapi/ppa && sudo add-apt-repository ppa:caffeine-developers/ppa && sudo add-apt-repository ppa:rye/ubuntuone-extras && sudo apt-add-repository ppa:screenlets-dev/ppa

Follow this by updating and upgrading any pre-installed packages with: -

sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get upgrade

Or by opening 'Update Manager' from the 'System > Administration' sub-menu and hitting 'Update'.

Install the themes

Install themes, icons, indicators and useful applications of your choice. The ones below are required to recreate the look:

sudo apt-get install faenza-icon-theme orta-theme emerald orta-emerald-decorators avant-window-navigator awn-applets-c-extras awn-applets-python-extras indicator-virtualbox caffeine ubuntuone-indicator screenlets screenlets

Wallpaper

The wallpaper used is 'Ubuntu Colored' by Deviant Artist ~[miel-g](http://miel-g.deviantart.com/art/Ubuntu-Colored). The entire pack weighs in at 44.5MB, so if you're on a slow or throttled connection you may have to exert a lot of patience at this junction.

- miel-g.deviantart.com/art/Ubuntu-Colored

Icons

I used '[MonoForAny](#)' to combine my favourite icon set - Faenza - with Ubuntu's mono-style icons (as in the AWN dock.)

Follow the instructions on the download page @ gnome-look.org to configure your theme.

Choose Ubuntu Mono Light and Faenza to mimic my desktop.

Theme

Lets get the theme set up first. Go to '**System > Preferences > Orta Setting Manager**'.

Feel free to adjust Orta to your own tastes as it won't make too much difference to the overall 'look'.

Finally, to apply the theme, click open '**System > Preference > Appearance**', choosing 'Orta'

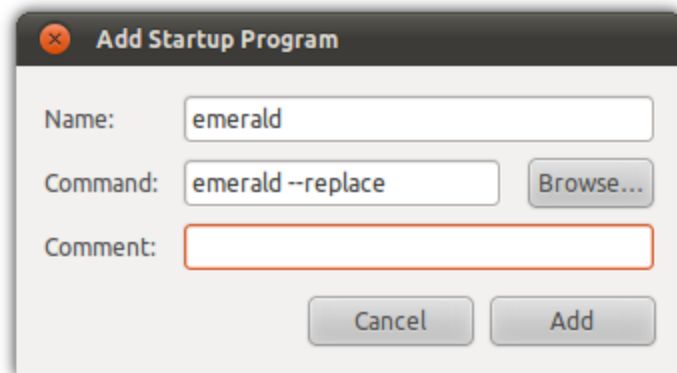
from the list of available themes. Press the 'Customize' button and chose the saved icons from the previous step.

Window borders

I also use emerald instead of Metacity.

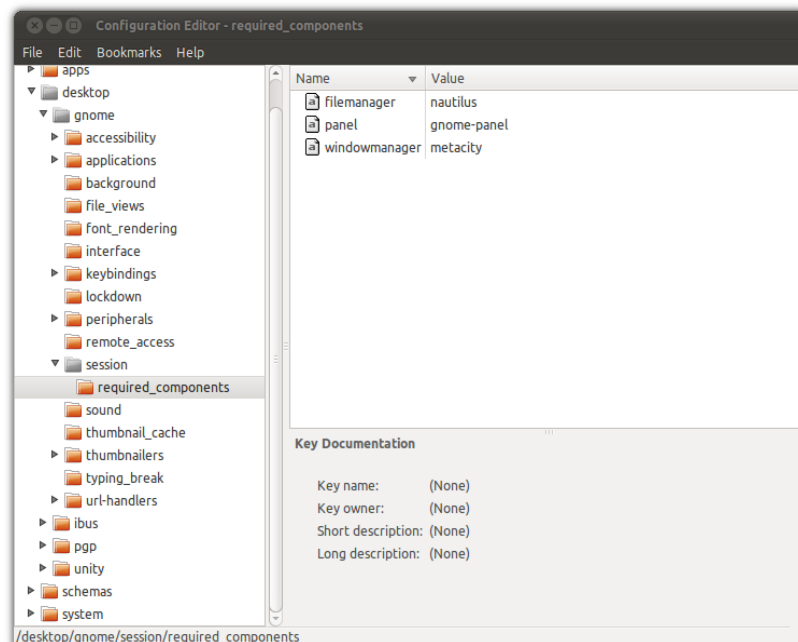
Go to **System > Preferences > Emerald Theme Manager**. Activate the Orta emerald theme and then, importantly, enable emerald by adding it to **Startup Applications**.

Go to System > Preferences > Startup Applications > Add New. Enter '*emerald --replace*' as command and 'emerald' as the name.



Replace GNOME-Panel with AWN

Press Alt + F2 together and enter '*gconf-editor*'. Navigate the tree menu to *Desktop > Gnome > Session > required-components*.



Next to the 'panel' entry double click on the '*gnome-panel*' text and replace with '*avant-window-*

navigator'. Finish up with by left clicking on this and selecting "Set as default".

Some people prefer to reboot by now, but I simply remove bottom gnome-panel and then open up Awn to configure everything before doing that.

Configure Awn

Start Awn via **Applications > Avant Window Navigator**. Enter the "Dock Preferences" by either left clicking on the dock or clicking on the blue icon.

Go to the 'Theme' tab and install my provided theme pack: -

- Download the Awn theme @ dl.dropbox.com/u/7918706/ortaawn.tgz

You can, if you so wish, tweak the 'Advanced options' using the settings below: -

- Advanced - Panel - offset = set to 5
- Advanced - Effects - Reflection alpha multiplier = set to 0.000

Configure the Applets

I removed the '*Preferences applet*' as well as activate the following: -

- Awn Main Menu
- File browser launcher
- Slick Switcher
- Cairo clock
- Indicator applet (will adjust things here later on)
- Notification daemon
- Weather applet

Position the applets according to your own tastes.

Add applications to the dock by going to "Task Manager" then 'drag and drop' applications from your current Gnome menu. My choice as in the screenshot was *Firefox, Transmission, Shotwell and Terminal*.

Configuration for indicator applet

Simply left click on an empty space on it and chose "preference", check all entries and then "options - enable applet icon mode".

Configuring Screenlets

Launch Screenlets from '*Applications > Screenlets*'.

Once opened, activate the 'RingSensors' screenlet and add as many sensors as you wish using the "Launch/Add" button.

Minimize the Screenlet Manager and left click on any RingSensor on your desktop to chose preference (RAM, CPU, etc)

Once you configured all sensors you must chose "Options" in Screenlet Manager and apply "Lock", "Sticky" and "Widget". Disable anything else and then chose "Re-Start All". Now your settings are saved. I also disabled the "Show daemon in tray".

Lastly, don't forget to set screenlets to run on login (there's a box you can check to do this).